Connect Firecrawl

Let your AI helper read whole websites as clean text, for research and site refreshes.

Kind Walkthrough | Changed 2026-11-04 | For Anyone connecting a helper

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TL;DR

1. **Firecrawl lets your AI helper read whole websites as clean text, in one request.**
2. It handles pages that need JavaScript and strips menus and cookie banners.
3. It can map every page of a site.
4. It's how a foundation refreshes its own website copy or researches others.
5. **Connect it once in the helper you use.** The free tier covers ordinary use.

> ***Handing this to your AI helper?*** *Say: "Read CONNECT-FIRECRAWL.md and help me connect Firecrawl to you. Stop and ask me before anything that needs a login or a key."*

Pick your helper

ChatGPT and Codex

1. Open Firecrawl's official plugin: https://chatgpt.com/plugins/plugin_asdk_app_6a314a73f8ac819195b0d55e36b9c609?q=firecrawl
2. Select **Connect** and sign in to Firecrawl (or create a free account).
3. In a chat, mention Firecrawl: *"Use Firecrawl to read https://example.org and summarise it."*

Claude (web and desktop)

1. Open the Firecrawl connector: https://claude.ai/directory/connectors/firecrawl
2. Select **Connect** and sign in to Firecrawl.
3. Ask: *"Use Firecrawl to map https://example.org and list its pages."*

Claude Code, Cursor and other code tools

Add Firecrawl's hosted server. It signs you in through your browser, so no key is stored in a file:

```
{
  "mcpServers": {
    "firecrawl": {
      "type": "http",
      "url": "https://mcp.firecrawl.dev/v2/mcp-oauth"
    }
  }
}
```

Claude Code: user-level servers live in `~/.claude.json` under `"mcpServers"` (not in `settings.json`). Restart Claude Code afterwards, then check `/mcp`.

Prefer an API key? Use `https://mcp.firecrawl.dev/v2/mcp` with your key as a bearer token, set in the tool's own secure settings or environment. Never put it in a repository.

What to ask once it's connected

- *"Map https://www.example.org and list every page with its title."*
- *"Crawl the site and save each page as markdown in `firecrawls/YYYY-MM-DD/`. That folder is private and never published."*
- *"Compare today's crawl with the last one and tell me what changed."*

Good to know

- **Free tier:** ample for a small site's refresh. A whole-site crawl of about 20 pages uses about 20 credits. Firecrawl also offers limited **keyless** search and scrape for trying it out.
- **The key, if you use one, only reaches Firecrawl.** It can't touch your email, Drive or GitHub.
- **Research stays private:** crawls go in the repository's private `firecrawls/` folder. The tripwire stops them from ever reaching the published site.
- **Be a good neighbour:** crawl your own sites freely; for others', keep it occasional and respect their terms.

Official setup guide: https://docs.firecrawl.dev/mcp-server

Suggest a change

Noticed something wrong, or know a better way? Open an issue or a pull request against `main`; the lab steward reads them, and a person with the role merges with a merge commit so your name stays on it. Not on GitHub? Tell any steward you know, or your helper, in your own words.

One of the walkthroughs in `my-template`. Icons: Lucide (ISC).